

📅 Microsoft Community Days Montreal · August 21, 2026

AI-Native Power Platform Development

Building from the IDE — an exploratory journey through what changes, what stays hard, and what remains ours to own.

Merci à nos commanditaires !





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Governance

Security

Developer Experience

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✦ We listen, and we don't judge.

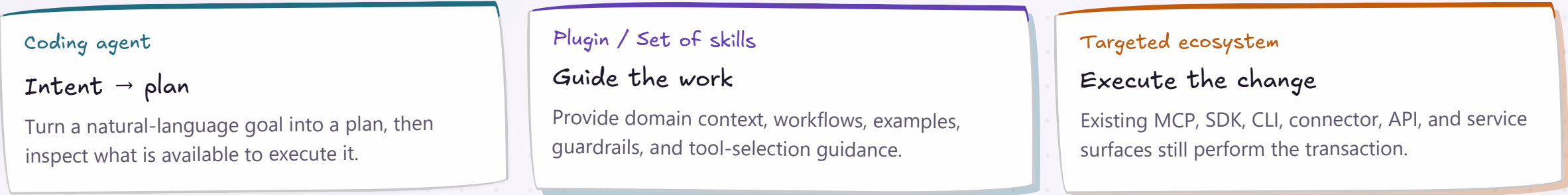
Is such shift really worth considering?

- 1 Who feels the pain of switching between several maker experiences to deliver one solution?
The portal is useful, the switching is the friction.
- 2 Is our destiny to entirely build solutions from an IDE?
Could feel appealing, but would it really be 🤨
- 3 What responsibility remains, whatever the interface?
That is the question this journey will test.

Technical introduction · Skills and plugins

What is a Skill?

A Skill is the bridge between a coding agent's intent and a properly executed plan.



“Skills orchestrate existing capabilities, they do not replace the capabilities of the targeted ecosystem.
The agent may interact with different surfaces depending on the task and available tooling.”

→ Technical introduction · Microsoft Power Platform ecosystem

What can these plugins help you do?

[microsoft/dataverse-skills](#)

Work with the foundation

Connect, query, import, model, secure, administer, and manage Dataverse solutions across environments.

[microsoft/power-platform-skills](#)

Build across workloads

A set of plugins to manage Power Apps experiences (canvas, model-driven...), Power Pages, and more recently Power Automate.

[microsoft/skills-for-copilot-studio](#)

Engineer standard agents

Author YAML topics, actions, knowledge, and variables. Then sync, validate, test, review, and troubleshoot.

[microsoft/copilot-studio-plugin](#)

Engineer newer agents

Create, edit, validate agents in the new experience or migrate agents from the standard harness to the GitHub Copilot one.

⚠ Experimental — not intended for production use

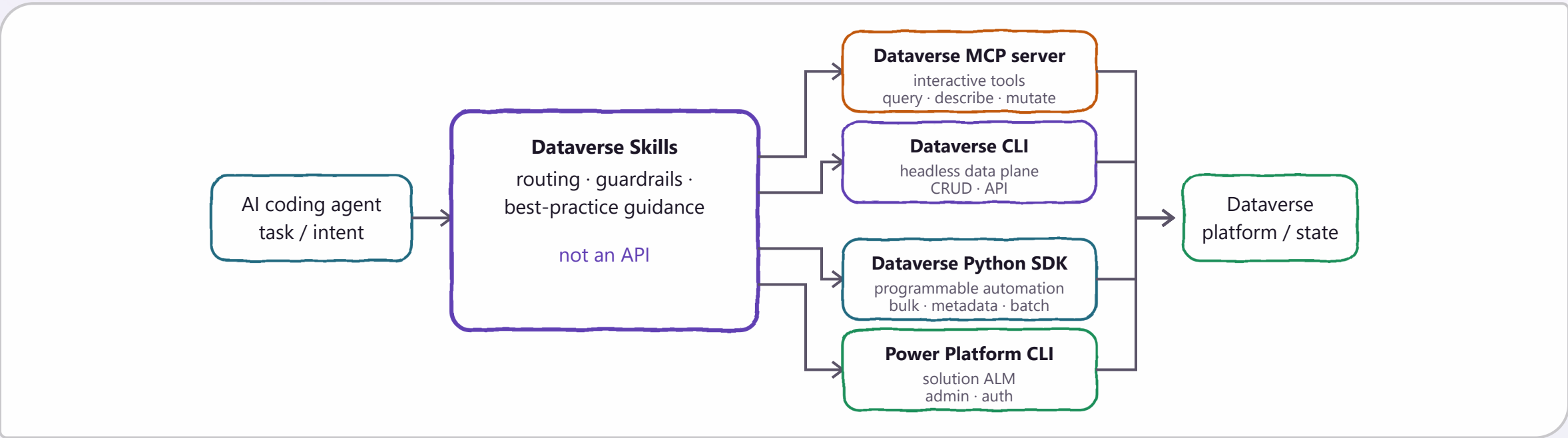


Now that coding agents know how to build solutions in Power Platform, is the next logical step to let them handle full implementations by themselves?

Our walkthrough will explore examples but the ecosystem is broader than the examples we can show today.

Technical introduction · Dataverse developer stack

Dataverse Skills choose the execution path



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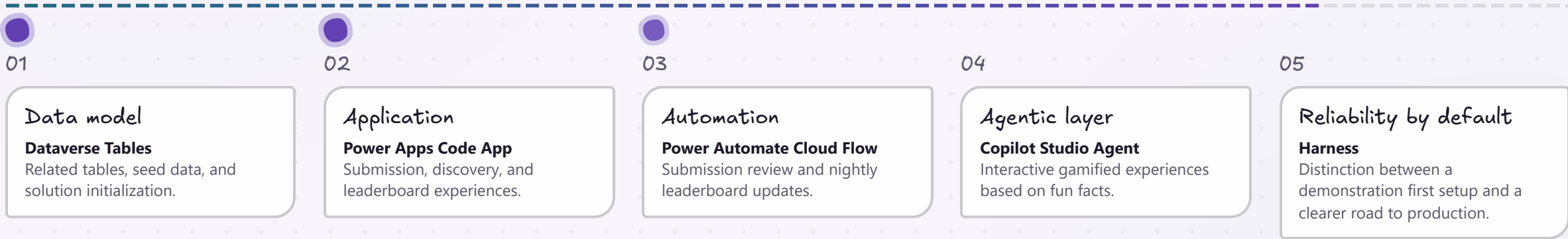
Four execution surfaces, one capability-aware router.

Skills choose MCP, Dataverse CLI, Python SDK, or PAC CLI based on the task, all enable interactions with Dataverse.

➡ One repository · one uninterrupted walkthrough

Follow me in my experimentation journey

During a few days, I used AI coding agents and Power Platform skills to build a solution spanning data, an app, an automated process, and an agent. This walkthrough follows coding sessions logs, the repository artifacts, and what they taught me.



Like digital archaeologists, we will explore what I went through to try to understand the potential of this approach.

☑ After the walkthrough · What the journey produced

The experiment produced evidence of what can be done

Our exploration journey enabled us to create elements proving building Power Platform solutions with the help of Microsoft skills is feasible. But were the skills the only factor that enabled us to achieve this result?



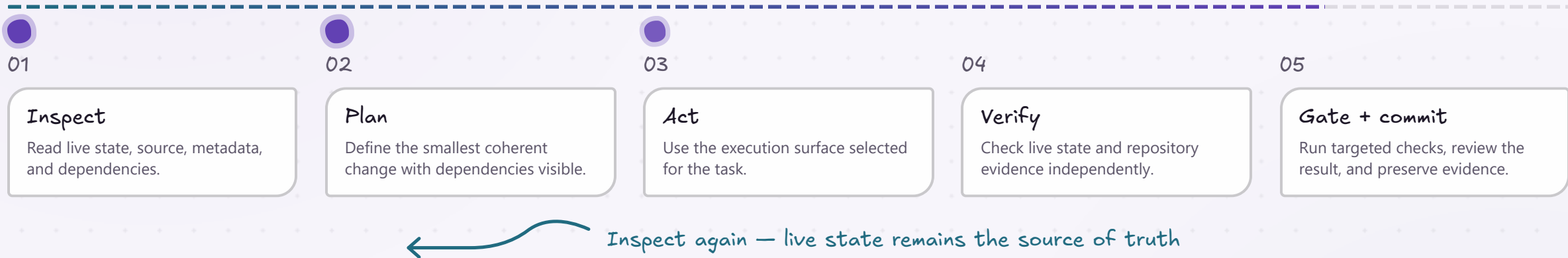
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At first it could feel like magic, but it is not. Giving the agent a reliable and trustworthy harness is what could make it realistic in the enterprise context.

Let's continue to see what I mean by that.

After the walkthrough · How goals can be achieved

The operating loop behind the smooth run



“
The skills help with the work, but the engineering loop enables the agent to achieve a goal autonomously.
This loop of reasoning, acting, and observing increases the chances of the agent to meet our expectations.”

✓ After the walkthrough · What enabled consistency and trustworthiness

The harness made the result good enough



AGENTS.md

Core instructions for architecture, naming, security, environments, commands, and the checks every session must respect.



Product + architecture baselines

Root PRODUCT.md defines the product vision and ARCHITECTURE.md anchors the data, agents, flows, apps, and ALM.



Frontend context

Shared code-apps/DESIGN.md keeps the visual system consistent and each app's PRODUCT.md keeps its product vision explicit.

Project Skills — route data, apps, flows, agents, and ALM through our team way of working while still leveraging Microsoft Skills

Impeccable Design Skills — use design hooks, critique, audit, and polish for frontend quality

“
A good harness enables you to walk away and let your agent do the work. It increases the chances to get good enough results to review and reduce the risk of chaos.

⌘ After the walkthrough · Lessons learned

What I would do differently now



Skills operating model understanding

Split the work to optimize how the considered skills will guide the agent to achieve the goal.



Keep as much as possible deterministic

Don't use AI-based approaches (instructions, skills...) to drive the part of your development process that should remain deterministic.



Model selection optimization

Planning is the phase where leveraging bigger models makes sense to benefit from stronger reasoning and broader context, but with a good enough plan, execution should be achievable with smaller models.



The economics of coding agents

If you are just watching coding agents working, their cost is most likely not worth it. Also, the AI nativeness of a tech stack will potentially become tomorrow something to consider architecting solutions.

☑ Beyond this experiment · Reliability frontier

What is still missing before production readiness

We did not have time to explore these deeply, but a reliable AI-powered workflow must eventually connect development to deterministic delivery and production feedback.



Deterministic CI/CD

Pin the path from commit to build, test, package, promote, and publish. Agents may propose changes but pipelines should still provide repeatable gates.



AI-powered operations

Observe live systems, synthesize incidents into issues, and let an agent propose a reviewed fix. AI offers opportunities to make our system more reliable.



Keep the agents in the loop, but you should stay in charge and accountable.

✓ Conclusions

Three ideas — plus one important nuance

- 1** Move the work, not the responsibility
Let an agent accelerate execution, while people still own architecture, security, review, and release.
- 2** Skills change the interface
They orchestrate existing MCP, SDK, CLI, and service surfaces. They don't completely reinvent the way we have been building solutions.
- 3** AI-native development is a workflow, not a prompt
A reliable loop — or, as we increasingly discuss it, an execution graph — plus a trustworthy harness are essential to meet your goals.

“

The portals remain valuable while the developer loop expands. Visual validation, exploration and more still belong where they are strongest.

🔗 Resources and next steps

Explore the same path — safely

Start here
[Power Platform Skills](#)

Install the plugin marketplace, then choose the workload skills that match your needs.

Foundation
[Dataverse Skills](#)

Guided connect, query, data, metadata, security, and solution workflows.
[Power Platform CLI](#) · [Python SDK](#) · [Dataverse MCP Server](#) · [Dataverse CLI](#)

Agent engineering
[Copilot Studio skills](#)

Author and validate Copilot Studio Agents whatever the considered harness is.
[Newer Copilot Studio plugin](#) · ⚠️ Experimental — not intended for production use

Coding host
[GitHub Copilot App](#)

Explore the agentic coding experience presented during the demonstration that can host these skills and plugins.



Companion repository · Poutine League demo

See the artifacts behind this talk and use them as a starting point for your own experiments.

github.com/rpothin/mcdm26-ai-native-powerplatform-dev

🔒 Closing

Thank you!

Q&A

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Drinks and Networking

Le Bar A – 17:00

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